



Standard Operating Procedure Food Waste Management

This document is subject to copyright and no part of it may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording or by any information or storage or retrieval system, without permission in writing from Empact Group (Proprietary) Limited.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

Document Control

Document Type	Policy		SOP	X
	Guidance Document		Other	

Division	Empact Food	X	Supercare	
	Empact Facilities		All	

Document Status	Draft		New	X
	Current		Obsolete	

Document Name	Food Waste Management		
Document No.	PROC40		
Document Version	V001		
Replaces	-		
Drafted By	Health and Safety Manager	Signature	<i>A Moodley</i>
Approved By	Managing Director	Signature	<i>K Moodley</i>
Effective Date	1 June 2026		
Review Frequency	3 years		
Review Team	Health and Safety Team		
Review Date	1 June 2029		

Reference Documents			
Doc. Number	Document Name	Version No.	Comments
F14a	Workstation Waste Record Form	V001	
F14b	Food Waste Tracker	V001	

Version Review			
Version	Review Date	Review Classification*	Reason for Review

**Major Review, Minor Review, New Document, Grammatical Review*

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

Purpose:	This procedure is to implement and manage a food and material waste management programme in all operating units. It also describes a measuring and recording system to minimize the amount of food waste generated in all food units.
Scope:	The purpose of this procedure is to ensure the effective management of food and related material waste across all operating units by standardising processes for measurement, recording, reduction, and responsible disposal.
Roles & Responsibilities:	<u>Project Manager / Catering Manager:</u> Responsible for ensuring compliance with this SOP at site level. Conducts regular inspections of waste management practices, ensures accurate recording and monitoring of waste data, and implements corrective actions where non-compliance is identified. <u>All Kitchen Staff:</u> Responsible for the correct segregation, measurement, recording, and disposal of all waste generated during daily operations in accordance with this SOP.
Accountable:	General Managers, Regional Managers, Key Account Managers
List of Applicable Definitions	
Waste Management	is the systematic process of collecting, transporting, treating, and disposing of waste to minimize its impact on the environment and public health.
Land Fill	The process of getting rid of large amounts of rubbish by burying it, or a place where waste is buried.
Waste Disposal	Methods used to discard waste such as recycling, composting, incineration, landfills, bioremediation, waste to energy, and waste minimization.
Waste Reduction	is the process of using fewer materials and creating less waste by reusing, recycling, or avoiding unnecessary consumption.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

Food waste is more than just discarded food, it is lost value, wasted resources, and environmental impact.

Every item thrown away represents water, energy, labour, and cost that cannot be recovered.

This procedure ensures that all food waste is properly managed, measured, and reduced to support environmental sustainability, cost control, and operational efficiency.

1. Environmental Impact:

Food waste and related materials, if not properly managed, contribute to environmental degradation. Disposal to landfill generates greenhouse gases such as methane, which contributes to climate change. Inefficient waste practices also result in unnecessary consumption of natural resources, including water, energy, and raw food materials.

Effective waste segregation, measurement, and reduction:

- reduce landfill disposal
- lower greenhouse gas emissions
- support more sustainable resource use within the operation

2. Financial Impact:

Food waste directly increases operational costs through:

- Unnecessary food purchasing
- Poor stock control
- Higher waste disposal costs
- Inefficient production planning

Effective waste control:

- Improves cost efficiency by reducing avoidable waste
- Improves stock usage
- Supports better planning
- Strengthens procurement practices.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

3. Daily Waste Management Process

- All waste generated within the operation must be segregated at source according to site requirements
- Waste streams may include, but are not limited to:
 - Food Waste
 - General waste
 - Recyclable paper and cardboard
 - Plastic
 - Glass
 - Tin
 - Used cooking oil
- Ensure all recyclable materials are disposed of in the correct recycling containers.
- All recyclable items must be clean and free from food contamination where possible.

Collection and Handling

- Refuse in food production and service areas must be removed regularly throughout the day to prevent overflow, pest activity, and unhygienic conditions.
- Food waste and other production waste must be separated.
- All refuse must be securely sealed and stored in designated external bins located a safe distance from kitchen and food handling areas.
- Waste must be segregated into wet and dry streams in line with site requirements.

Used Cooking Oil

- Used cooking oil must not be sold or given to staff for human consumption, as it may become toxic if over reheated.
- Only approved registered service providers may uplift used oil-
- Certificates / Invoices of oil collection must be retained for audit purposes.
- Collection volumes and dates must be recorded in the food waste tracker in litres.
- All other food waste must be separated, weighed and recorded on the food waste tracker daily in their respective categories.
- Kitchen waste bins must be emptied as often as possible, and always at the end of each day.
- After emptying, all bins and containers must be thoroughly cleaned and sanitised before being returned to any food preparation or handling area.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

4. Food Waste Categories

Food waste is classified into the following five categories:

Category	Definition	Example	Stage
Production Waste	Waste generated during the preparation and production of food	Vegetable peelings.	Pre-cooking pre-service
Over Production Waste	Food that is left over after service, including left over function food.	Scrambled eggs left over from the breakfast service. Cooked vegetables, starch and meat left over from the lunch service.	Post service
Unused/Expired Food	- Expired food items. - Products that are past their use by / best before date.	Expired fruit/vegetables/meat Expired canned food	Pre-cooking
	- Unused / Open / Decanted product that is no longer safe to eat. - Defrosted products that have not been used / cooked.	Expired meat or canned goods	
Plate Scrapings	Food waste that is returned to the kitchen or scullery on consumer or patient plates.	Corn cobs Bones Uneaten food	Post service
Food Retention Samples	A 100g sample of each prepared meal is stored in the refrigerator for 96 hours		After 96 hours

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

5. Resources and Tools for Food Waste Measurement and Recording

- a) Clearly labelled Food waste collection containers
- b) Calibrated scale to measure food waste
- c) Food Waste trackers and Workstation record form
- d) Clearly labelled Designated food waste bin/s
- e) Bokashi Bins / Composting bins (Where applicable)

6. Food Waste Measurement Process

6.1 Setup

- a) Ensure all workstations (grill, deli and preparation areas) are correctly set up with the required waste bins, including workstation bins, bulk waste bins, and scullery bins.
- b) Use dedicated clipboards for recording daily food waste figures consistently and accurately.
- c) Place waste collection containers conveniently at production areas such as the grill, deli, and other preparation stations, while ensuring they remain out of customer view.
- d) Provide a Workstation Waste Record form at each workstation where food waste may be generated to enable accurate recording.
- e) Provide a clearly labelled large bin exclusively for food waste to discard all weighed food waste.
- f) No packaging, dirt, or other materials must be disposed of in this bin.
- g) Ensure the bin lid is kept closed when not in use.
- h) Ensure the food waste scale is operational and calibrated, clean, before use.
- i) Any damaged or inaccurate scale must be removed from service and reported to management immediately.

6.2 Measurement and Reporting

- a) Using a calibrated scale, tare and record the weight of the empty waste container.
- b) Once each container is full of food waste, weigh it and record the total mass in kilograms on the Workstation Waste Record form.
- c) Each designated staff member must complete the Workstation Waste Record form, capturing unit details, type of waste (e.g. vegetable peels), and their name.
- d) Before disposal, food waste must be inspected by a manager or supervisor to verify contents and compliance.
- e) At the end of each day, all Workstation Waste Record forms must be submitted to the person responsible and captured onto the Excel Food Waste Tracker.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

- f) The Food Waste Tracker must be completed daily and submitted to the Regional Manager by the 3rd working day of each month, with Regional Managers submitting consolidated reports by the 5th working day.
- g) Failure to complete food waste records or submit monthly reports within the required timelines must be investigated and corrective action implemented.
- h) The Project Manager / Catering Manager is responsible for conducting weekly and monthly food waste analysis and discussing findings with their staff.
- i) The Weekly/Monthly analysis will identify trends, non-conformances, and operational practices contributing to excessive food waste.
- j) Food Waste Trackers, Workstation Waste Records, used oil collection certificates, and waste-related reports must be filed for audit purposes.

6.3 Disposal

- a) Once food waste has been measured, recorded, and verified, it must be disposed of in accordance with site-specific waste management procedures and sustainability initiatives.
- b) This may include Bokashi bins, Bio Bins, other approved composting facilities, or a food waste bin designated by the client.

6.4 Sanitising of Containers

- a) All waste containers must be washed and sanitised daily.
- b) Containers must be used for food waste measurement only to prevent cross-contamination and reduce food safety risks.
- c) Waste areas must be cleaned and sanitised regularly to prevent pest activity, odours, and contamination.

7. Food Waste Reduction Plan

- a) All units must develop, implement, and maintain a Food Waste Reduction Plan aimed at reducing avoidable food waste across all food waste categories.
- b) The Food Waste Reduction Plan must be based on food waste data, trend analysis, operational observations, and opportunities identified during monthly reviews.
- c) The Food Waste Reduction Plan must be reviewed monthly by the Regional Manager and updated as required.
- d) Progress against waste reduction initiatives must be discussed during management reviews and corrective actions implemented where waste reduction targets are not being achieved.
- e) Evidence of the Food Waste Reduction Plan and related improvement initiatives must be available for audit purposes.

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.

8. Education and Training

All staff must be trained on:

- Environmental and financial impact of food waste
- Daily waste measurement and recording process
- Correct waste categorisation
- Their role in waste reduction

Additional requirements:

- A Food Waste Champion must be appointed per unit
- Training must be documented and filed
- E-learning training must be completed by all staff
- Refresher training must be conducted regularly

The electronic version of this document is the approved and most current version. Any printed version is uncontrolled and may not be current.